

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible “false flag”) and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE’s own government and predating Aug 18; that “novel escalation vector” framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as “the first confirmed fatality” in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia’s “2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis” infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot (“at least 15”), and IMO’s own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat “18th death” — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 “Operation Economic Outcast” package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman’s own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran’s Larak Island — the first US strike on

Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026**, retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX**

September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft): CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kilo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day

intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Salldrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement

in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** Committed by Alex; Sept 13-14 light daily catch-ups held flat with nothing new clearing the sufficiency bar, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 16 (score set 2026-09-16_draft):** RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12/36mo windows to 1/1/14/33/66 (from 1/1/18/38/70) — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council, and 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a Sept 12-13 statement calling for NPT withdrawal, with a hardline MP describing an emergency bill being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News); Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons stance and the Foreign Ministry's "still being prepared" framing kept the move modest. AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **THIS VERSION (Sept 17, score set 2026-09-17_draft) HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66** — re-checked, no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's and the Foreign Ministry's positions are unchanged. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **Sept 18 (score set 2026-09-18_draft, this version) HOLDS FLAT again at 1/1/14/33/66.** Two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders — dated and multi-sourced (Axios original, corroborated by Times of Israel, Politico Wire, Breitbart, RedState, Western Journal, anews — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty, so it does not clear the bar for a further move. Separately, an initial general search surfaced a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 18; a follow-up targeted search could not independently corroborate this from any named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source — **treated as NOT FIRED / NOT USED** per this report's house discipline for uncorroborated single claims. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (Sept 19, score set 2026-09-19_draft) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-09-18_draft) — independent primary-source research across all five windows found nothing that clears the sufficiency bar for a move. Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging the legal Article X process, Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done, and a bill was submitted for expedited consideration — but Iran's own Foreign Ministry still calls it "in preparation," so this remains a proposal, not a completed act (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated, the same treatment this pillar has always given Iranian-sourced claims). Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman) — very well corroborated (Axios, Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News, 5+ independent), but still rhetoric about an undated future decision; **the Sept 22 meeting itself is now flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.** The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel, Russia and China dissenting (Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) — a primary UN press release (press.un.org, sc16455 and related), corroborated by Euronews and Security Council Report — institutional gridlock over the 2025 snapback dispute, not a new sanction or act of war. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18) this pillar could not corroborate last cycle is now CONFIRMED via the IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org) plus independent outlets including The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, and Rio Times — reversing last cycle's NOT FIRED call, but it is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P. Brent settled ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (CNBC, Al Jazeera), down 1.5% day-over-day but still near the multi-month highs reached in early September — a market price, not scored. Iran has now gone nine straight days without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, fragile de-escalatory data point — while a Houthi-linked air-raid alert hit Riyadh Sept 19 for the first time since July (Times of Israel liveblog) — a mixed signal on the proxy front; neither clears the bar alone. FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified the Oman understanding will NOT by itself reopen Hormuz, conditioned on the US honoring the 60-day Islamabad MOU (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa) — a net wash. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66 — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.** See My Decision below. **Updated & Re-verified September 22, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-22_draft: carried forward unchanged at 1/1/14/33/66 — not re-researched this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down instead. COMMITTED, AUTO-**

STAMPED SEPTEMBER 22, 2026. Updated & Re-verified September 23, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-23_draft: RE-RATED UP to 3/3/16/35/66, the first upward move since Sept 13. A senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22, 8+ outlet corroboration) Iran can reopen Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases pressure and lifts its blockade; separately, US officials (Witkoff/Kushner) and Iran's FM Araghchi held a 3-hour "very productive" mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines Sept 22, the first direct US-Iran contact at this level since the war began, with another meeting scheduled soon. Sized modestly against Iran's still-steep unmet conditions (full blockade lift, all frozen assets released, end to war on every named front), Pezeshkian declining to meet Trump directly, and continued unattributed Sept 21 tanker incidents. **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 23, 2026.** A Sept 24 light daily draft proposed a window split (3/3/16/35/66 → 2/4/17/35/66) on Trump's unpriced Sept 22 UNGA "right after the election" remark, but was never rendered, selfchecked, archived or committed — abandoned, superseded. **The Sept 26, 2026 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-26_draft3)** independently re-researched the week, briefly re-rated Iran UP to 2/5/18/36/66 on FM Araghchi's on-record seven-day Hormuz plan (Sept 25), then WITHDREW that move on Sept 26 after Trump rejected the plan himself, on the record ("I reject their proposal") — landing at **1/2/15/34/66**, one point above the pre-Sept-23 floor on 3mo/6mo/12mo because Trump's own post-election dealmaking prediction and Pezeshkian's conditional offer to readmit UN nuclear inspectors are both still live. **COMMITTED BY ALEX, September 27, 2026. Updated & Re-verified October 3, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-10-03_draft: HOLDS FLAT at 1/2/15/34/66.** Independently re-verified against the Sept 26/27 committed baseline: the shipping war intensified (UKMTO confirms a Kuwaiti VLCC, the Al Funtas, struck Sept 28, plus three more vessels struck Sept 29 — no casualties, no individual attribution) and diplomacy stayed deadlocked on sequencing (Araghchi's Doha meeting with Qatari mediators Sept 29-30; Rubio had Iran's UN delegation leave New York early Sept 30 after talks "stalled," which Iran's mission disputes as pre-scheduled) — both bearish. Offsetting: Brent pulled back off its Sept 24-25 spike, closing below \$100 on two of four sessions (Sept 29, Sept 30, and again Oct 2, after popping back above \$100 Oct 1) — downgrading this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause from clean-FIRED to fired-but-weakening — and there is still no new confirmed US combat death, no resumed direct US strike on Iranian soil, and no widening to a further state. Neither side clears the sufficiency bar; the two nets roughly cancel. **LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT auto-stamped — this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero) — AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW.**

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · **Updated & Re-verified October 3, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-10-03_draft: HELD FLAT at 1/2/15/34/66.** Independently re-verified via fresh primary/multi-tanker, ADNOC LR2 Al Ruwais struck Sept 29, no casualties, no individual attribution — and diplomacy stayed deadlocked on sequencing (Araghchi's Doha meeting with Qatari mediators Sept 29–30; P. spike, closing below \$100 on two of four sessions (Sept 29 \$96.16, Sept 30 \$97.46, Oct 1 \$102.25, Oct 2 ≈\$99.5) — **downgrading the sustained-Brent->\$100 flip-line clause from clean-FIRED to fired-but-weakening** — and there is still no new confirmed US combat death, no resumed direct US strike on Iranian soil, and no widening to a further state. Neither side clears the sufficiency bar; the two nets roughly cancel. **1/2/15/34/66 (2026-09-26_draft3, COMMITTED BY ALEX September 27, 2026).** · Prior: Updated & Re-verified September 26, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-26_draft3: RE-RATED UP to 3/3/16/35/66, the first upward move since Sept 13. A senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22, 8+ outlet corroboration) Iran can reopen Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases pressure and lifts its blockade; separately, US officials (Witkoff/Kushner) and Iran's FM Araghchi held a 3-hour "very productive" mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines Sept 22, the first direct US-Iran contact at this level since the 3/3/16/35/66 (2026-09-23_draft, auto-stamped Sept 23) · Not Financial Advice · **Updated & Re-verified September 24, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-24_draft [NEVER DELIVERED — yesterday's cycle and logged as such — put a deal "right after the election."** The Nov 3 midterms fall outside the 1mo window and inside 3mo/6mo, so 1mo comes down a point and 3mo/6mo go up one point. **NON-HOSTILE** and does not fire the combat-death flip line.

6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	18
1 year	75	...	54	51	50	47	47	45	44	43	42	40	38

3 years	85	...	76	75	75	74	74	73	73	72	72	71	70

Prior committed P (2026-09-22_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped): 1 / 1 / 14 / 33 / 66 · Prior committed P (2026-09-23_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped, RE-RATED UP): 3 / 3 / 16 / 35 / 66 · Current P (2026-09-24_draft, light daily touch, auto-stamped, RE-RATED UP): 4 / 4 / 17 / 36 / 67 · President Trump's Sept 22 UN General Assembly address — which yesterday's cycle scored the same-day Witkoff/Kushner-Araghchi meeting but never mentioned — put a deal "right after the election." The midterms are Nov 3, which is a week after the election.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 14, LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15_draft): RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from the Sept 13-committed 3/3/18/38/70). Meeting that was to be held on Monday in Salalah, in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue." **No new date was set.** Corroborated by Arab News, the Washington Post, and the UAE had already downgraded to a minister of state rather than its foreign minister. Iran's MFA spokesman says Saudi Arabia requested the postponement citing the Yemen war and ca Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz" (Tehran Times / Mehr — Iranian state media quoting Iran's own foreign minister, primary for Iran's stated position). **what was checked and rejected:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Salalah and Duqm ports; those are dated **March 1, 3 and 11, 2026**, not September, and are NOT treated as new events (the postponement and Oman's FM publicly recommitted to dialogue), 36mo 70 flat.

Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70 (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four paragraphs covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and the Sept 10 UKMTO Warning 133-26 near Khasab): **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary oil export route** — was hit by a series of strikes. **PRIMARY:** Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage (OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing fire/smoke at pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekra. Iraq's PM ordered a probe of the Maysan operations command, dismissed its commander in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED statement, logged as exactly that, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes the strikes to "a series of attacks" so this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one; the US-casualty clause does NOT fire — no confirmed US military casualty found this cycle. The sustained-Brent->\$100 clause was privately signaled to the administration they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, consistent with (not additive to) the already-logged MBS-twice-refused to use maximum restraint," and expressing concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, diplomatic, long-horizon data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun (Perimeter) warning was found beyond the already-logged Warning 133-26. **Sizing:** a third distinct attack on Saudi oil infrastructure this week, specifically targeting the kingdom's Hormuz-bypass export route. US casualty, so sized small: 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat (a single tactical strike doesn't change the long-run strategic outlook, and the BRICS restraint statement is a modest offset). **move size — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily, score set 2026-09-12_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70 (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40/71). **BEARISH and NEW: a second global oil price drop** — an offensive that by Sept 11 captured Dhubab and Murad — the final coastal towns held by the internationally recognized Yemeni government — giving Iran-aligned Houthi forces control of Yemen's oil outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald) and is materially more severe than the "closing in" status the Sept 10 cycle priced — actual control of strait-control was refused (intelligence/targeting-data support offered instead) — a genuine US-restraint data point, logged as an honest counterweight. Per this pillar's own flip-line definitions, Yemen/the Houthis' escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment (the direct-US-strikes and sustained-Brent clauses both fired in prior cycles), not a fresh flip-line event. **BEARISH and NEW, second fact:** the Houthis' setting one afire; corroborated by 3+ independent outlets (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill). **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-source):** IRGC's own claim to have separately destroyed a vessel (TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the flip-line clause that already fired Sept 10-11, not a fresh trigger. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo held at the near-floor 2** — recent 1-point touches but still restrained since no flip-line newly fires — the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet bar (UKMTO's own warning, not a single outlet, for the vessel strikes);

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and this is a repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, Kharg Island, U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — but this is a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line that not-yet-executed threat) remains in the same state — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified/forthcoming, so it is not re-scored a second time. This is a continuation/intensification of the (further room), 3mo 7 → 6, 6mo 24 → 23, 12mo 44 → 43, 36mo 73 → 72. This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar (Alex (auto-stamped))."

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). BEARISH a (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) states US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (p warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded multiple attacks, no American personnel were harmed. Admiral Brad Cooper, CENTCOM's commander: "If you claim, with AP framing it as an accusation and CENTCOM silent) — it is now primary-sourced and multiply corroborated, and it reveals a materially more serious escalation than a quiet single in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live blog, Euronews) are IRGC's own claims only — not yet US-confirmed, so per the sufficiency rule they are NOT independently used to move P; watch Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/Uk markets closed Saturday) — still short of the \$100 sustained-flip threshold. The c light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up: P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. I yet a sustained new campaign" — that assumption is undercut by what happened next. A THIRD Hormuz tanker was hit Aug 31: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity, struck by three missiles. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents. Iran's army (not IRGC) claimed a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base near Dubai; the UAE denied it. The US target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed-as-a-hit) attempt to widen beyond the repeat-target Jordan pattern. Jordan was struck again Aug 30-for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not signaling de-escalation. Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports), so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause on its own — neither the "confirmed new US combat death" clause nor a clean "further new state struck" clause fires cleanly. This is a 6mo 34 → 32, 12mo 51 → 50, 36mo 75 → 75 (flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, ABC News, Seatrade Maritime, Iran International, and UKMTCTV. Hawkins confirmed on the record, corroborated by 20+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, etc.), cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken") — firing two missiles at two US-linked airbases in Jordan (King Hussein, Al-Azraq); Jordan's military said it intercepted 8 missiles, and Iran claims "heavy damage" to base infrastructure — unconfirmed by either side. A comparable single-incident shock: 1mo 14 → 9, 3mo 22 → 17, 6mo 38 → 34, 12mo 54 → 51 and 36mo 76 → 75. Prior to that, the Aug 29 full weekly refresh had held P flat at 14/22/38/54/76 on a good day. Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Day") and sb0614 (Bessent's remarks), plus an OFAC recent-actions entry dated 20260824 — corroborated by state.gov analysis of the UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five sectoral determinations (EO 13902). Critically, this is the FIRST TIME digital assets were explicitly named as a sanctionable sector under this program. The primary confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant — a genuine escalation. It continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation. Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents occurred. CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper gave an on-record briefing Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared Iranian ships from the Gulf. has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed — read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a new shock. IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary source) showed a shock. **BULLISH AND CONFIRMED: Oman's own Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a Hormuz corridor, Aug 25.** Directly fetched from fm.gov.om/en/53722 (Oman's own government site) — confirmed a corridor (entry/exit through Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as a spokesman claim (Aug 26) of an Iran-Oman revenue-sharing deal remains single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded from scoring, same treatment as prior single-source claims. Hormuz transit-volume increase of the entire crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quasi-primary shipping data, 2 independent sources). Crisis eased for a SECOND straight week: ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from a third straight week of decline. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the standing casualty total, not a new event) — the flip line remains unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran. pillar's own explicit upside flip line — a signed, US-accepted Hormuz deal holding a full clean week without a new attack/fatality/seizure — is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" windows.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 15. In the prior context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the real, visible risk-off pullback logged when this pillar's evidence last moved sharply negative.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 16, 2026 (light daily touch, P re-rated down on the 6/12/36mo windows as the nuclear track escalates alongside the shooting war)

This cycle (Sept 16): the crowd's attention today is almost entirely on the CLARITY Act vote failure, not Iran — but two real, dated escalatory facts landed this week on the nuclear track that this but bounded — a parliamentary push and an institutional referral are documented facts, not a completed NPT exit, and Pezeshkian's own public no-nukes line plus the Foreign Ministry calling the pillar's floor of 1 with no room left to express further deterioration. The shooting-war facts this pillar has tracked for weeks — the Saudi pipeline, the Salalah postponement, Hormuz shipping — still

Prior cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petroline pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss the kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a refinery this time) for the third time this week, and that pattern — not the unconfirmed attribution — is what earns a further infrastructure strike with no widening (Iraq is already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) and no US casualty — not because I am siding with either the "Iran did it" or "no proof, ignore it" either.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" back on islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one, and that upgrades the standing risk even though no clause in this pillar's own flip line technically fires (Yemen is existing through falsifiable definitions — and I'd rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify a bigger move. The MBS-request-refusal

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles when it hadn't fired yet; the discipline only counts if it also fires when the number arrives. What it does *not* is a further modest cut, not a regime change — and the give-back on diplomacy headlines is logged honestly alongside it.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise. Both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time either — a repeat-pattern event, not a new category. The Houthis seizure of Mocha is more interesting precisely because structural development worth flagging even though no blockade has actually been executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more important tell than either strike or this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires — so it does not independently fire that clause, though it earns a mention in every relevant section below responding to the same kind of provocation (an IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event, so I am re-rating down

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new street — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed incident tied to it as of this cycle's research cutoff. Re-rating down modestly (1/7/24/44/73, from 1/8/25/45/73) rather than sharply on escalatory statements. I am explicitly not treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish either — until it is actually signed, it's too

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fired on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent short of \$100). Separate IRGC claims of further tanker/vessel/drone strikes were explicitly not used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficiency rule is exactly what stops

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real story this cycle.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, and political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced at the level that matters (Iranian state/local authorities, CENTCOM neither confirming nor denying ~50x the Aug 30 strike, plus the war's first direct tanker strikes — is a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak) don't cleanly cover ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the cut is still evidence-bounded, not panic-sized: kept under 8 points per window, and the four-count

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation and crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to size around it instead.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own shadow honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of October 3, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-10-03_draft). Hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from this cycle appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.

★ NEW THIS CYCLE — THE WEEK OF SEPTEMBER 26–OCTOBER 3, 2026

★ NEW — a four-vessel strike cluster in the Strait of Hormuz, Sept 28–29, UKMTO-corroborated. On Sept 28 the Kuwaiti-flagged VLCC **Al Funtas** was struck in the Strait of Hormuz with VLCC **Mersin Prosperity**, one unnamed inbound tanker, and the ADNOC LR2 **Al Ruwais** — no casualties on any of the three. Multi-sourced (Maritime Executive, gCaptain, Energy Intel, GulfWatch) ongoing contested-Strait pattern but is not independently attributed fact-by-fact.

Hormuz transit data — genuinely mixed, reported both ways rather than blended into one number. Windward vessel-transit counts show **6 transits Sept 25, 13 Sept 26, 25 Sept 27** (vs baseline, while refined-product flow stayed depressed at **677k bpd vs. 3.6M bpd pre-war** (≈19% of normal). These measure different things — vessel-transit counts vs. barrel-flow volumes —

★ NEW — diplomacy stayed deadlocked on sequencing, Sept 29–30. Iran's FM Araghchi received formal US feedback on his seven-day plan via Qatari mediators in Doha; the confirmed multiple outlets citing the same Reuters original — single-origin, not independently multi-sourced, under the sufficiency rule. Separately, on **Sept 30** Secretary Rubio ordered the Iranian UN d (Israel). Iran's mission disputes the characterization, saying the departure was per a schedule communicated Sept 17. **Reported as a confirmed factual dispute, both sides' claims on record.**

Nuclear file — a repetition, not a new concession. President Pezeshkian reaffirmed (Fox Sept 24, a CBS "Face the Nation" transcript dated Sept 27, Borna News) that IAEA inspector access not been withdrawn. No evidence found of any actual IAEA verification activity on the ground in this window.

No new confirmed US combat death; no new direct US strike; no widening. DCAS holds at **19** — the circulating "19th death" talk is the same Sept 18 non-hostile in-flight medical-emergency consecutive no-strike days" as of Oct 1-2 could not be primary-verified (centcom.mil blocked to automated fetch in this sandbox). No new country was added to the conflict — the two Houthis-

★ NEW — the Brent price sequence, Sept 29–Oct 2, and the flip-line downgrade it drives. Brent: Sept 24 \$106.60 → Sept 25 \$104.37 → **Sept 29 \$96.16 → Sept 30 \$97.46 → Oct 1 \$100.00** sessions in this window (Sept 29, Sept 30, and again Oct 2) after popping back above \$100 on Oct 1. **This downgrades the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause from a confirmed to a reported but explicitly not scored.**

REPORTED BUT EXPLICITLY NOT SCORED. The WSJ's unnamed-source claim (already excluded from the Sept 26 baseline) that Trump told aides a post-midterm bombing resumption is in the rule, but flagged prominently as a **3mo-window watch item** since the Nov 3 midterms fall inside that window.

NET ASSESSMENT this cycle: the shipping-war intensification (UKMTO-confirmed, genuinely worse than baseline) is bearish; the Brent pullback is bullish but volatile/unsettled; the diplomatic

Carried forward from the prior cycle (still load-bearing):

★ NEW, PRIOR CYCLE — THE WEEK OF SEPTEMBER 19–26, 2026

★ THE LOAD-BEARING NEW FACT — Iran's foreign minister put a concrete plan on the record, Sept 25, 2026. FM Abbas Araghchi, speaking to reporters *outside the UN Security Council*, observes a ceasefire on all fronts including Lebanon and Yemen; **the Strait of Hormuz reopens on day six**; and **US–Iran talks on a final nuclear deal begin on day seven**. In his words: "I was carried by AP, Reuters and Al Jazeera as independent originals — a categorical upgrade over the anonymous sourcing that this pillar has repeatedly refused to score. *Sourcing precision:* the words: Araghchi framed the US steps as not new — "They are all already in the MOU" — which ties the plan to the existing Islamabad framework rather than presenting it as a fresh concession."

★ NEW — Pezeshkian offers to readmit UN nuclear inspectors, in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25. Asked whether Iran would allow UN nuclear inspectors back in, President Pezeshkian said, *Sunday, Sept 27 broadcast*, not a Sept 25 interview aired in full; the concession is explicitly **conditional on the US accepting Iran's proposal**; and the softening versus his own defiant Sept 24 of force." Even so, inspector access is the first movement on the nuclear file in weeks, and it is the specific reason the 12-month window takes +1.

★ NEW — Secretary Rubio on the record, Sept 24: the previous day's talks were "largely positive" and "human beings talked to each other yesterday," but he *declined* to call it a breakthrough.

CORRECTION to the Sept 23 committed set — the Sept 22 contact was MEDIATED, not direct. That set called it the “first direct-channel” US–Iran contact. Witkoff’s own on-record account **rather than smoothed over**: Iranian state broadcaster IRIB described it as a *meeting* between Araghchi and Witkoff held at Witkoff’s request, and Trump said his envoys “met with” the Iranian

★ **FALSIFIED CLAIM — a cargo vessel WAS struck in Hormuz on Sept 23.** The abandoned Sept 24 draft stated that “no new tanker incidents dated Sept 23-24 were found.” That is **wrong** — the *Alia* was evacuated, with **two casualties** reported. **Careful wording, because the sources genuinely do not say more**: UKMTO did *not* state whether the two casualties were killed or injured, so the 19 Indian nationals aboard) — not to UKMTO. Either way these are **merchant crew, not US service members**, so the US-combat-death flip line is untouched. *Basis caveat*: ukmto.org returned

★ **NEW — two Houthi salvos at Saudi Arabia.** On **Sept 24** Saudi forces intercepted **six ballistic missiles** aimed at Taif and the Yanbu Red Sea area; overnight **Sept 25–26** the coalition intensified the **clause**: Saudi Arabia is a repeat target already in theatre, and everything incoming was intercepted.

★ **NEW STATE OF AFFAIRS — no announced US strike on Iranian territory since Sept 1, roughly 3.5 weeks.** The strikes clause that fired Aug 30 is therefore now **DORMANT, though not** (Partner Military Operations) plus the absence of wire coverage — wire/ISW-derived, not primary-verified. A discrepancy is flagged rather than printed: secondary sources date the follow-up

US fatalities — the flip line did NOT fire, with three corrections to the record. The Pentagon’s DCAS total stands at **19**, unchanged through Sept 26, and breaks down as **11 hostile plus** non-combat-related and a defense official described a medical incident aboard a flight to Saudi Arabia. It is explicitly non-hostile, so this pillar’s flip line, which requires a confirmed new US combat death, more US troops have died than the Pentagon has disclosed; the article returned 403 and could not be read. It is potentially material to this flip line and needs a dedicated pass.

MARKET PRICES AND SHIPPING DATA — labelled, never presented as institutional estimates. Brent closed **\$106.60 on Sept 24, up 3.4%**, with an intraday high of **\$108.23**, then closed at **\$107.23** — now stale. **Hormuz transits show no recovery**: Reuters shipping data has transits falling to **nine on Thursday Sept 24** from 14 the previous day, against a **10-day average of 18**, versus a 10-day IMF PortWatch reading of one transit is dated Sept 20 *and* uses PortWatch’s own 85/day baseline, so it is not comparable with the Reuters series and the two are not mixed; Reuters also covers the (lineage). Prediction-market quotes on a US–Iran ceasefire are excluded entirely this cycle: the market definitions conflate Israel–Iran with US–Iran, so no number is quoted.

REPORTED BUT EXPLICITLY NOT SCORED — and the most important one cuts AGAINST this cycle’s up-move. (a) The Wall Street Journal reported Sept 25–26, citing *unnamed US sources*: Bloomberg, CNBC, The Hill, JPost, Ynet and others all headline it as a *WSJ report*, and there is **no on-record White House confirmation** anywhere as of Sept 26. WSJ’s own caveat: **report applies that rule symmetrically: the item argues for a smaller up-move or none, and is still not used.** (b) The National’s Sept 23 “road map” remains single-original-source; Semantics seven days via Qatar — and the two are deliberately **not merged.** (c) An IRGC claim of a cluster-warhead anti-ship missile test near a US carrier (Sept 20, via Al Jazeera) is Iran’s own uncorroborated

- ★ ★ **NEW — the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) on Sept 18, 2026 to renew the panel of independent experts monitoring** the ground, so it doesn’t move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Trump told Axios (Sept 17, 2026) he faces a “big decision” on whether to “annihilate” the Iranian regime, ahead of a planned Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly session** (independent). Rhetoric about an undated future decision, not an action — this pillar’s clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.
- ★ ★ **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle’s “not fired” call**: the Togo-flagged tanker “Trend” strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18, 2026 is now confirmed via the IRGC’s *Alia* — months-long tanker campaign, not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran’s nuclear file to the UN Security Council.** A primary institutional action by the IAEA itself, escalating international
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for Iran’s withdrawal from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty** — two are Iranian state-affiliated, so treated as corroborated reporting of a documented parliamentary act rather than independent Western confirmation.
- **Counterweight, same sourcing set**: President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons, even as the parliamentary push proceeds. Foreign Ministry spokesman Ebrahim
- **Nothing new found** on the Salalah Iran-GCC ministerial (still postponed, no new date), the Saudi East-West pipeline (still offline), or Hormuz shipping beyond what the Sept 15 baseline already

Carried forward from the September 12 full weekly refresh and the daily touches since — still load-bearing, not contradicted:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia’s East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom’s primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi Ministry of Defense)** — causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad’s request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com — 6+ independent).
- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully**: no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Presidio
- **Neither flip-line clause fires**: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT
- **Counterweight, logged**: Trump’s own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don’t want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, “maximum restraint” and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr framing only), not used to move P.
- **Re-verified independently**: the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye)

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen’s entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seized** — CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen is existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire.
- **Counterweight, logged**: Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support only
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO’s own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf of Oman)
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P**: IRGC’s own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM
- **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired “sustained >\$100”
- **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the “sustained Brent close above \$100” flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent). Three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and
- ★ ★ **NEW — fuller reporting of the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of strikes** — US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire.
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P**: a compilation of Hormuz transit data puts throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day moving average of 10-13 commodity vessels
- **Counterweight, logged**: Friday Sept 11’s ~3% Brent give-back is attributed to diplomatic efforts around the Strait of Hormuz and to the IEA’s forecast of a 2.5 mb/d contraction in 2026 demand
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan’s Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, in retaliation for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike** — Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, a SECOND global shipping chokepoint** — closure or interdiction has actually been confirmed — outlets describe Houthis as “closing in on,” not as having executed a blockade.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session**, more persistent than Sept 9’s single-day intraday cross (CNBC: above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9) — call.
- **NEW — no widening to a further new state and no confirmed US casualty**: Jordan is a repeat target, and CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties from the Al Azraq strike; DCAS reports
- **BTC traded at \$77,063 on Sept 11** — down from \$77,993.99 on Sept 10 and \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 (local full quant refresh this cycle, run .py quant).

Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T RedState** (GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM’s own press release (“US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship”) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.–Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC “Brent crude tops \$100 as

- NEW — both Iranian missile attempts on the US Navy warship were evaded, no US personnel harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired.
- NEW — no widening to a further new state: Gulf of Oman and Kharg Island are both existing theater already struck in this war.
- Iran's Sept 6-7 SNSC "restricted zone" announcement remains not-yet-executed — no new dated development, not re-scored a second time.
- BTC traded at \$79,052.40 on Sept 9 — up from \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 and \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beyond the Strait of Hormuz "in the coming days." The zone was confirmed by Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iranian state media (Press TV, Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- This is a threat of intent, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details, including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced." Rezaei separately said as much.
- GlobalSecurity's Day 192 (Sept 7) tracker puts the blockade count at 92 vessels redirected, 3 disabled, 2 boarded — up from Day 190's 87/3/2 (Sept 3), a continuation of the already-confirmed.
- BTC traded at \$78,435.62 on Sept 8 — down from \$79,090.41 on Sept 7 and \$80,338.98 on Sept 6 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5, resolving the tanker report this pillar had withheld. The tankers were hit by ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded multiple attacks with no American personnel harmed. Corroborated by Al Jazeera, Reuters, and others.
- This revealed a materially more serious escalation than the Sept 5 baseline knew: not a quiet single-tanker interdiction, but a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels.
- Sept 6's IRGC claims of further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels and a US naval drone (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remain US-unconfirmed as of this writing.
- BTC traded at \$79,929.30 on Sept 6 — up from \$79,646.11 on Sept 5 (data via the GitHub Actions fetch workflow).

Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing):

- ★ CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, roughly 50x the scale of the Aug 30 Larak Island strike. Targets included IRGC air-defense sites, radar installations, and other military infrastructure.
- ★ ★ NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported Trump-approved "tanker for tanker" policy — confirmed by multiple sources.
- ★ ★ NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tuesday Sept 1, its best session in 5 weeks, to ~\$95-96.6/bbl; WTI to ~\$91-92 — still short of the \$100/bbl flip line.
- ★ ★ NEW, FLAGGED SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED — a US strike on Kuestak, Sirik County, Hormozgan (near the Strait) reportedly hit a wedding party. The Hormozgan governor denied it. The casualty claim itself originates with Iranian state/local authorities — wide Western-outlet pickup of that one narrative is not the same as independent multi-sourcing of the underpinning.
- ★ ★ NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries simultaneously: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait (Al Jazeera, Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points Feb-Jul 2026), so the "widening to a FURTHER NEW state with confirmed attribution" flip-line clause does NOT fire.
- NEW — most projectiles were intercepted: Jordan (~10 of 25 intercepted, 3 landed, no reported casualties); Bahrain (most of roughly two dozen drones intercepted). No confirmed new US casualties.
- NEW — both sides now on-record threatening larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military official threatened further strikes.
- BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2 — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting. The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles in the Gulf of Oman, following already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents — the third such hit in the same window.
- ★ Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES that base was targeted while CONFIRMING a separate cross-border drone strike. An Iranian drone detected over UAE territorial waters, approaching from Iran. So: a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion — reported via CBS News, Al Jazeera, and others.
- ★ President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — expected.
- Brent crude continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday per multiple market-desk reports) on fresh-clash fears — the session after the long Labor Day weekend, the second straight of gains.
- Jordan was struck again Aug 30-31, but remained a repeat, not a "further new," state per this pillar's own framing (already struck Jul 28 and again as part of the Aug 30 IRGC retaliation) — confirmed.
- BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson plus 20+ independent outlets. US forces struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers in the Gulf of Oman. Reported via Reuters, Newsweek, ABC News, Al Jazeera, Fox News, RFE/RL, Epoch Times, Daily Caller, OANN, FXStreet, Korea Times, India TV, and Time. The first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since the 2020 strikes.
- ★ IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement plus multi-source reporting. IRGC said it hit two airbases. The strikes were confirmed by multiple sources, including the Jordanian military. The strikes were confirmed by multiple sources, including the Jordanian military. The strikes were confirmed by multiple sources, including the Jordanian military.
- Press (Reuters/CNBC) framed the renewed exchange as weighing on Asian equities and US futures, reversing the prior two-week Brent decline.
- BTC traded at \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 — up from \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing):

- ★ "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov. Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign to Isolate Iran's Economy") and others. Intelligence outlets (TRM Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and South Korea. Unlike prior cycles' "promised but not landed" sanctions rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722. A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle, the corridor was a US/UK/Oman joint effort (not Oman's own), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself said so. Single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded.
- NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents. Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, vessel damaged, no casualties, UKMTO).
- NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28 (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared the Strait of Hormuz, evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a fresh shock.
- NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest since 2011.
- NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25 with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quantitative, genuine first uptick).
- NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week: ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further from the \$100/bbl flip line.
- NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29 (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the Sept 1 report).
- NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents at the Strait of Hormuz.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6, per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz campaign itself.
- **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft base.
- **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) of an Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" — genuine or not.
- **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a conclusion.
- **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by the Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier *Al Safir* was struck on Aug 21 by a missile, killing 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility yet. **Re-verified this cycle (draft2): the cumulative toll is now 10 deaths.** Reason this cycle is left as a draft rather than auto-stamped.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker *Amara* was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under a 2015 UN Security Council resolution.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to the Aug 22 deadline.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile hit the Abu Dhabi coast.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of the Aug 18 embargo, which was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the deadline, saying "the conflict will be resolved in a timely manner." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd hand out a check" to Oman.
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM's Aug 16 report of 110 transits is more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera) and Aug 15 (Reuters). The UAE called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) report the UAE's demand for \$100 million in compensation to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.
- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24).
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni government. The Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direction.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9,** a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (Saudi press) reported the strike.

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) reports the UAE's demand for \$100 million in compensation, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait.

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier *Gaslog Shanghai* was struck and disabled carrying 160,000 cu m of gas. More explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at a critical level."
- ★ ★ **NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7,** wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with brain injury).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that may be significant.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping,** banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA). The dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not independent.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called for continued attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time).
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.

- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle"
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wan

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecur was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a fir
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhal since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Tru
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework w
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing within 30 days. The US aimed to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalizatio
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit th
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, V turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Is
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — dire management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourc CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~**Aug 16** remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel–Iran exchange since June 7–8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors,
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~**\$98,225 intraday low**, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~**\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~+25-
The Aug 30-Sept 2 direct US-Iran exchange escalated sharply (a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, a four-country Iranian retaliation), res but has not been confirmed reopened either. As of this cycle (Sept 19), the picture is mixed rather than clearly escalating further: Iran has gone nine straight days without striking a "host state" 19, up sharply from \$78,046.80 on Sept 18 — this pillar's own P held flat this cycle, so that move tracks other pillars' news (notably nothing that cleared any pillar's own bar this week), not this fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a full clean week without a new attack, fatality, or seizure, would shift the prize from "temporary corr the Prize doesn't feed the math, it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of mag this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the cut "under 8 points per window" mechanically, out of habit from smaller prior incidents, is itself a mistake when the unde
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, b caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidentiary gap.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself said in advance this class of event was different in kind, not just degree.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign re the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets a
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a rea
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchang

- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen. Neither moves P (one is purely diplomatic, the other single-source as to substance), but this pillar logs every n scoring decision is defensible.

The Triggers

dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. **As of Sept 19 (full weekly refresh):** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike is now CONFIRMED (reversing the Sept 18 NOT USED call, but not moving row below); and the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional gridlock, a new row broke. None of this clears the sufficiency bar; P HELD FLAT. **As of Sept 18:** Tr UNSC referral (Sept 9) and the 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal push (Sept 12-13) are the newest entries, driving this cycle's 6/12/36mo re-rate down. Re-levaled August 22, 2026, refreshed August 29; **this pillar's own downs** wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct IRGC missile attack on 2 US Navy warships; Iran's SNSC secretary announces intent to declare a res base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10 closing in on Bab el-Mandeb. **As of Sept 11 a SECOND, distinct flip-line clause has now fired** — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" clause, on moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line clause (top row). **As of the Sept 13 light daily touch, the first de-escalation datapoint in six weeks landed:** Iran first such gathering since the war began in February (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ independent outlets). It drives this pillar's first UPWARD re-rate since Aug 6, sized small against Bahrain's announced projectile on Jazan, ongoing Bab al-Mandeb combat). It does NOT fire the upside flip line, which requires a signed, US-accepted Hormuz reopening holding a full clean week. In the prior Sept 12 full weekly refreshed (hedged remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires. **As of Oct 3 (FULL WEEKLY refresh):** a four-vessel strike cluster hit the Strait Sept 28-29 (UKMTO-corroborated, no at closes (Sept 29, Sept 30) and a third (Oct 2) sandwiching one pop back above \$100 (Oct 1). No new US casualty, no new direct US strike on Iran, no widening. None of this clears the sufficiency bar; P HELD FLAT.

DATE	EVENT
FIRE Sept 25 — DE-ESCALATORY, named principal ON THE RECORD, 3 independent originals	FM Abbas Araghchi detailed a SEVEN-DAY plan outside the UN Security Council, conveyed to Washington via Qatar: ~4–5 days of US steps (estimated \$12bn in frozen assets, ceasefire on all fronts including Lebanon and Yemen), Strait reopens day six, nuclear talks begin day seven. Reuters and Al Jazeera as independent originals. He added the US steps “are all already in the MOU”
FIRE Sept 25 — DE-ESCALATORY, nuclear file, but CONDITIONAL	Pezeshkian offers to readmit UN nuclear inspectors in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25 ahead of the Sunday Sept 27 broadcast: “That is absolute commitment to” — explicitly if the US accepts Iran’s proposal. Materially softer than his own Sept 23 UNGA address on inspector access specifically
FIRE Sept 23 — ESCALATORY, and it FALSIFIES the abandoned Sept 24 draft	A cargo vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait of Hormuz, caught fire, lost control and drifted; crew evacuated; two casualties occurred Sept 23–24 — wrong. UKMTO did not say killed or injured, so this report does not say “two killed”; the vessel is the Antares; confirmed fatality is attributed to the Indian Embassy in Oman (19 Indian nationals aboard). ukmt0.org 403’d — wire-derived, not primary-verified
FIRE Sept 24 and overnight Sept 25–26 — escalatory, multi-source	Two Houthi salvos at Saudi Arabia: six ballistic missiles intercepted toward Taif and the Yanbu area (Sept 24); two more plus two drones toward Jeddah (Sept 25)
DORMANT as of Oct 3 — a previously fired clause remains lapsed	No announced US strike on Iranian territory since SEPT 1, now over four weeks. centcom.mil still returns 403, so this negative continues to require verification. Unconfirmed, flagged rather than relied on: a secondary claim of “25 consecutive no-strike days” as of Oct 1-2 could not be primary-verified
DOWNGRADED Oct 3 — FIRE BUT WEAKENING, market price	Brent closed BELOW \$100 on two of four sessions since Sept 26: \$96.16 Sept 29, \$97.46 Sept 30, popped back to \$102.25 Oct 1, then ~\$98 same ICE future, objective market data). Supersedes the Sept 26 baseline’s “\$106.60 Sept 24 / \$104.37 Sept 25, nowhere near un-firing” read
FIRE Sept 28–29 — escalatory, UKMTO-corroborated, no individual attribution	A four-vessel strike cluster in the Strait: the Kuwaiti VLCC Al Funtas struck Sept 28 while transiting dark (AIS off), fire extinguished, no casualties; vessels — Mersin Prosperity, an unnamed inbound tanker, and ADNOC LR2 Al Ruwais — struck Sept 29 (UKMTO advisories issued Sept 30), no casualties; Executive, gCaptain, Energy Intel, Gulf News, WAM, TASS, Seatrade Maritime, Newsquawk). No individual attribution (Iranian claim or formal US confirmation)
DEADLOCKED Sept 29–30 — diplomatic; sequencing dispute single-origin, delegation departure multi-sourced	FM Araghchi received formal US feedback on his seven-day plan via Qatari mediators in Doha; the confirmed sticking point is sequencing (Iran wants concessions first) — single Reuters-origin wire, not independently multi-sourced. Separately, Rubio ordered Iran’s UN delegation to leave New York City — multi-sourced (AP/ABC News, Washington Times, US News, Jerusalem Post, Times of Israel); Iran’s mission disputes this, saying the departure was never intended
NOT FIRE — checked Sept 26, no recovery	Hormuz transits: nine on Thursday Sept 24 from 14 the previous day, 10-day average 18, against a pre-war baseline of ~125 large commercial tankers per day, 14% of normal. An IMF PortWatch reading of 1 is dated Sept 20 and uses PortWatch’s own 85/day baseline — not comparable, and not mixed
NOT FIRE — the combat-death clause, with three record corrections, re-checked Oct 3	Pentagon DCAS holds at 19 through Oct 3 (11 hostile, 8 non-hostile) — unchanged since Sept 18; the circulating “19th death” talk this cycle is false; 19th was Capt. Bianca C. Wilkerson, 37, posthumously promoted to major, who died Sept 18; DCAS lists the cause as “undetermined,” not terrorism
REPORTED, NOT SCORED — and it argues AGAINST this cycle’s up-move	The WSJ reported Sept 25–26, citing UNNAMED US officials, that Trump REJECTED the seven-day plan and expects to resume bombing Iraq; source: Bloomberg, CNBC, The Hill, JPost and Ynet all cite the WSJ; no on-record White House confirmation exists. WSJ’s own caveat: Trump may change again”
REPORTED, NOT SCORED — still single-original-source	The National’s Sept 23 60-day “road map”: Semafor attributes it verbatim to “The National reported” rather than confirming independently. It is not with Qatari/Pakistani/Egyptian mediation versus seven days via Qatar
WATCH — the next concrete signal either way	Whether the US responds ON THE RECORD to the seven-day plan. Rubio called the Sept 24 talks “largely positive” but explicitly not a breakthrough; said Sept 25 it “will not stop punishing the US until Iran’s seven conditions are met”
FIRE Sept 24 (event dated Sept 22) — on-record, multi-sourced, this cycle	President Trump’s UN General Assembly address, Sept 22, 2026 (Axios, NBC News, CBS News, Times of Israel, PBS, Bloomberg, Washington Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News — 5+ independent) — he made with Iran that lets them rebuild and create a far greater country than it ever was before ... or do I annihilate the Islamic Republic, and do deal right after the election because it doesn’t make sense for them not to. They’re waiting to see how I do in the midterm election.” Not priced by Witkoff/Kushner-Araghchi meeting but not the speech — that omission is logged, not folded in quietly
Sept 23 — REPORTED, NOT SCORED (single-narrative source)	The National (Sept 23) reported Iran presented the US a “road map”: a nationwide ceasefire of up to 60 days, phased Strait of Hormuz reopening via Qatari, Pakistani and Egyptian mediators. Gulf News and Aaj English TV carry it but label it “report” in their own headlines — syndication of the WSJ
Sept 17, reported Sept 17-18; UPCOMING Tuesday Sept 22 — dated, multi-sourced (Axios original, plus Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News — 5+ independent)	Trump told Axios he faces a “big decision” on whether to “annihilate” the Iranian regime or not, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly address (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman)
Struck Sept 17-18 — CONFIRMED via IRGC’s own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint) plus independent outlets (The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, Rio Times)	The IRGC struck the Togo-flagged tanker “Trend” in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18; crew reported safe, no confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmation
Sept 7-13, still unenacted as of Sept 19 — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anewz, Militaryny, IFP News)	Iran’s parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging President Raisi to withdraw; Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal “can easily” be done; a bill was submitted for expedited consideration but not yet voted on; “still being prepared”
Sept 18 — PRIMARY (UN press releases sc16455 and related) plus Euronews and Security Council Report’s monthly forecast	The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing) to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposed Iranian sanctions and Pakistan abstaining, deepening the ongoing Russia/China-vs-E3 legal dispute over the 2025 “snapback” sanctions reimposition

Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo News)
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory : CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observing prep work on Iran since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted 8 missiles; US/Jordan beyond interception; no confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 entities/sectoral determinations; FIRST TIME digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by multiple firm alerts; continued Aug 28 with a Bank Melli-Dubai designation
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor (entry/exit) for continuing talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran itself said it would comply
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents : Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties (US Navy) — crew safe (UKMTO). Neither incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force satellite intel (multiple corroborating) — the Aug 27 tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing : Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; US naval enforcement began; ~75 turned back, 3 disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times)
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis : +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29% uptick)
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military sources) — but Oman's own Foreign Ministry did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of US; US is "obstructing this process"
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death . One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in previous report
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign : bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22 : tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible "false alarm"
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran
Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned ; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal ; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (softened to "no timeline")
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see The Factbook)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, The Hill)
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman condemns Iran
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions) — IMO toll 19 dead
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a full war
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending

· This pillar's signals (unchanged from the committed baseline): 1mo -4.70 (Very Strong Bear) · 3mo -4.99 (Very Strong Bear) · 6mo -3.92 (Strong Bear)

COMMITTED BY ALEX — SEPTEMBER 27, 2026 (2026-09-26_draft3) · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH · THIS PILLAR RE-RATED (WINDOW SPLIT)

Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13_draft), prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above: ONE sufficiency-cl
Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz — specifically safe and temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term management of the water
statement, describing the gathering as an effort "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security." Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets I
and sized in — they are why this is +2 points and not a reversal: (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will NOT attend, so GCC participation is incomplete; (2) an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that
transiting vessels, which arguably institutionalises rather than lifts the blockade; (4) the kinetic war did not pause — on Sept 13 a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing
mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes with Yemen's internationally recognised government over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13). **Market corroboration, reported as a market**
the already-logged IEA demand forecast. **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The downside clauses already fired (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sep
meeting at which no deal is expected is not that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo held at 70 (one announced meeting does not
decision: this is an ordinary light daily touch, research capability (WebSearch/WebFetch, primary sources) was fully available, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-poll
this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)". The direction of the move does not change that test: the same rules that justified six weeks of downward re-rates j

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex’s manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars. The ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia’s East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — was hit by drones launched from Iran** — stations near Riyadh/Medina were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad’s request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, etc.) — border crossing. **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state; President Trump, in Dublin, called Iran’s strike on US facilities in Erbil province — this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty this cycle). The sustained-Iran involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit’s joint declaration (Sept 12, all members present) — Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held — how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, flagged prominently for Alex’s manual review.**

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from “closing in on” to actual island-level control, giving them Yemen’s entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island in the strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, etc.) — counterweight, logged honestly. Separately, UKMTO’s own Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire); an IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike is single-source — a casualty clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event, but is a bigger step than the routine daily grind. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/2/18/38/70 – 1** — clean — under the runbook’s widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the severity of the underlying news is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by “Alex (auto-stamped).”**

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft), prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar’s own **“sustained Brent close above \$100” flip-line clause has FIRED**. Brent ended the day at \$101.25 (TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. That is three consecutive strikes — Sept 10 run logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday’s level — an intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked strikes, 8 US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire either. Logged but not used to move P: a single compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7 trillion barrels per day, 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5 → 4, 6mo 22 → 20, 12mo 42 → 40, 36mo 72 → 71. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full (WebSearch/WebFetch working, local sources confirmed), **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by “Alex (auto-stamped).”** CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check; Fed & Macro re-rated up modestly after the August CPI print.

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft), prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike (Iran confirmed, corroborating Jordan’s own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck previously Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire; CENTCOM/Jordan both confirm no casualties — rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM’s own no-casualties statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb — the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a further new state), and no strait closure or shipping interdiction has actually been confirmed yet — out of the second straight session (CNBC: Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Thursday Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9’s single-day intraday cross. This is a repeat-pattern regional strike plus a new-but-same-actor Yemen/Red Sea territorial escalation, both intensifying the trend already priced without crossing any flip-line threshold. Cut applied to 3mo/6mo/12mo — more than 1 point, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER’s call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) —

Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM’s own press release (“US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship,” centcom.mil) confirmed the US destroyed five IRGC tankers with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days. Corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM’s own release — clear, existing theater, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause does not fire either; this is a repeat pattern, not a fresh category of event. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday today (Sept 9) for the first time since the come to the flip line, but a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar’s own “sustained Brent >\$100” threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause either. Iran’s Sept 6-7 SNSC “restricted zone” announcement — same escalation trend the Sept 6/8 cycles already priced, not a fresh flip-line event. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7 → 6, 6mo 24 → 23, 12mo 44 → 43, 36mo 73 → 72.** — stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by “Alex (auto-stamped).”**

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran’s SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that Iran’s “no-fly zone” over the Oman corridor agreement would be signed “in the coming days.” Corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to Iran’s own statements — boundaries, have yet to be announced, and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle’s research cutoff. None of this pillar’s flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIA remains 18 (unchanged since Sept 4) (up from Day 190’s 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 7 → 6, 6mo 24 → 23, 12mo 44 → 43, 36mo 73 → 72.** — band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook’s delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by “Alex (auto-stamped).”**

Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft), prior cycle: CENTCOM’s own on-the-record press release (centcom.mil) now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had explicitly withheld on (permanently disabled near Jask), and M/T Kylo (completely destroyed in the Gulf of Oman) — in retaliation for the IRGC firing ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile cruiser) — sufficiency bar the Sept 5 baseline explicitly withheld on, and reveals a direct, unprovoked IRGC missile attack on US Navy vessels rather than a quiet single-tanker interdiction. Separately, Sept 6 (today) confirmed the move P; watch next cycle. None of this pillar’s flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS still shows 18 confirmed US deaths (unchanged since Sept 4), Kharg Island/Jask/Gulf of Oman are all existing theaters. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar (CENTCOM’s own release), and the master FINAL NUMBER’s equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral). **stamp authority, this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by “Alex (auto-stamped).”**

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night strike was confirmed. Developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts who concluded the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding-party strike was likely a direct hit by a US missile — responsibility (VP Vance: “extremely skeptical,” Sept 4, calling it under investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution of an ALREADY-PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than describing new escalation or independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. WATCH NEXT CYCLE: if independently confirmed, the Sept 3 strike, Taher ridge would trigger a “large-scale attack” on Israel; the IDF took the ridge Sept 3, but no such attack has been confirmed as of this run — a live pending trigger, not a fired one. **P HELD FLAT at 1/9/17/37/70** — corrected retroactively.

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version: independently re-verified via WebSearch. The Sept 5 tanker report has firmed up considerably since the daily touch a few hours earlier: confirmed by a broadcaster editorially independent of and adversarial to Tehran — obtained video of three US radio warnings ordering the crew to abandon ship before the strike, corroborating that a strike and warnings of a strike were confirmed or denying this specific strike as of this research pass (distinct from CENTCOM’s on-the-record July 14-15 naval-blockade doctrine, under which the Curacao-flagged M/T Belma was disabled via a US strike independent-of-the-accusing-party corroboration of that specific fact; Iran International’s video corroborates that warnings were issued and a strike occurred, but does not independently confirm US authorities’ claims that the Belma was destroyed). The Sept 5 tanker report’s clauses independently fired this week regardless: no confirmed new US combat death (standing count remains 18 per GlobalSecurity Day 189), no widening to a further new state (Sept 3’s Kuwait/UAE strike was **categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size (here, zero) — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX September 5, 2026.**

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact:** Iran’s strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported “tanker for tanker” policy. A US strike on Kuhestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party (Hormozgan governor’s office: 4 of at least 5 killed) — for Iran’s response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targets, so the widening-to-a-new-state clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what’s driving the size of this move.

P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY: 1mo 7 → 1, 3mo 15 → 9, 6mo 32 → 27, 12mo 50 → 47, 36mo 75 → 74. Every window moved under 8 points, but this is the largest front-loaded cut since the Aug 30-31 flip-line event. The “Iran proper” clause is escalating sharply in scale, which is what’s driving the size of this move.

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not flat — Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a further, larger cut.

Why this was originally left as a draft Sept 2, pending manual review: (1) the core wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of that day’s four-country retaliation — is single-narrative-sufficiency-clearing; (2) the jump in scale — nearly 100 targets and the war’s first-ever direct tanker strikes, versus two rocket/mine-launchers on Aug 30 — was a genuinely novel escalation this pillar’s prior single-incident-sufficiency-clearing cut. It also independently flipped the master FINAL NUMBER’s equal-weight call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) versus the last stamped set — under the rules in force that day, this alone disqualified the set for stamping.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle’s research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are now determined by the narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. Nothing about the underlying facts, sourcing, or the sizing of the cut changed — only the stamping threshold was lowered.

Historical note: the paragraph above was the Sept 2 cycle’s original manual-review flag, superseded by the Sept 3 auto-stamp policy widening and, again, by this cycle’s own auto-stamp. Left here for the record.

What Changed Since Last Check

FULL WEEKLY refresh, October 3, 2026 (score set 2026-10-03_draft, LEFT AS DRAFT, awaiting Alex’s manual review) — checked against the last COMMITTED baseline, 2026-09-26_draft3 (1/2/15/34/66, committed by Alex) — supersedes and deepens them.

★ ★ FULL WEEKLY refresh, Oct 3 (score set 2026-10-03_draft) — HOLDS FLAT at 1/2/15/34/66, on a genuinely two-sided ledger. BEARISH and NEW: a four-vessel strike cluster in the Red Sea (Sept 29) — all UKMTO-corroborated, no individual attribution. Diplomacy deadlocked: Araghchi’s Doha meeting with Qatari mediators Sept 29-30 surfaced a sequencing dispute (single Reuters report, Sept 29) — four sessions since the baseline (\$96.16 Sept 29, \$97.46 Sept 30), popping back to \$102.25 Oct 1 before easing to ~\$99.5 Oct 2 — **downgrading the sustained-Brent->\$100 flip-line clause** —

- further state. **Flagged, not scored:** the WSJ's single-origin claim that Trump told aides a post-midterm bombing resumption is "likely" is logged as a 3mo-window watch item (the Nov 3 midterms — this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero).
- **Oct 3 light daily touch (quant-only; qualitative set unchanged):** re-checked this pillar via WebSearch, including explicit searches for Oct 2-3 dated developments. Results found all trace of statement, strike, or casualty found. **HOLD FLAT — nothing cleared the sufficiency rule.** config/scores.json untouched; active set remains 2026-09-26_draft3.
 - **Oct 2 light daily touch (quant-only; qualitative set unchanged):** re-checked this pillar via WebSearch. Dated material found all traces to the Sept 25-26 Araghchi proposal / Trump rejection. config/scores.json untouched; active set remains 2026-09-26_draft3.
 - **Oct 1 light daily touch (quant-only; qualitative set unchanged):** re-checked this pillar via WebSearch against the Sept 26 baseline. Found two offsetting, multi-sourced developments since total shutdown), while Brent nonetheless eased ~7% off its Sept 24-25 spike; and (b) the US and Iran exchanged a formal proposal and counterproposal via Qatar (Iran confirmed receipt Sept 26, though IAEA reports no actual verification activity on the ground). No new US casualties, no new direct US/Israeli strikes on Iran, Houthi pattern unchanged (repeat targets, all intercepted). **nothing cleared the sufficiency rule.** config/scores.json untouched; active set remains 2026-09-26_draft3.
 - ★ **★ THIS CYCLE REVERSED ITS OWN CALL, and the reversal is logged in full rather than presented as the original conclusion.** An earlier draft of this same Sept 26 cycle scored Iran's original reasoning and the reason it failed are kept below, because a reader should be able to see the judgement change and audit it.
 - ★ **★ THE DECIDING FACT — PRIMARY, Sept 26:** speaking to reporters outside the White House, Trump said **"I reject their proposal," "I've rejected their deal,"** and "that deal would not be a deal." remarks. **The only person with authority to accept the plan rejected it on the record,** so under the sufficiency rule this both may and must move P.
 - ★ **★ THE CATALYST THAT IS NOW DEAD — Araghchi's seven-day plan, Sept 25.** Outside the UN Security Council, conveyed via Qatar: ~4–5 days of US steps (lift the blockade, waive oil embargo, independent originals; Araghchi added the US steps "are all already in the MOU." Real, well-sourced, and *refused* — which is why it ends up reversing the Sept 23 bump rather than extending it).
 - **Why NOT a full reversal to the old 1/1/14/33/66 floor.** Two things are genuinely new since that floor, both on the record. **(1)** Trump paired the rejection with "I like making a deal too" and had a deal. **(2)** Pezeshkian offered on the record to readmit UN nuclear inspectors ("That is absolutely correct"), in a CBS excerpt released Sept 25 ahead of the Sunday Sept 27 broadcast — conditional on US steps.
 - **STILL NOT SCORED, and this is where the rule bites hardest — the excluded claims are the *most bearish* ones.** The WSJ's other assertions — that Trump privately told aides he expected a deal, claim circulating this cycle that *senior White House officials confirmed on record* they have "no intention of dismantling" the blockade was checked and **could not be found at all**; that exact pillar is not merged.
 - **LIVE CONTRARY EVIDENCE, weighed not buried:** Reuters (Sept 25–26, unnamed US official) has the US in "positive, constructive discussions with Iran through mediators" on the nuclear deal. reason this pillar does not fall below its prior floor.
 - ★ **★ FALSIFIED — a cargo vessel WAS struck in Hormuz on Sept 23,** caught fire, lost control and drifted; crew evacuated; **two casualties.** **UKMTO did not specify killed or injured, so the claim is not scored.** crew, not US service members, so the combat-death clause is untouched. ukmt.org 403'd, so this is wire-derived rather than primary-verified.
 - **CORRECTION to the Sept 23 committed set:** it called the Sept 22 contact the "first direct-channel" US–Iran contact. Witkoff's own account says the talks ran "through the mediators, who still have a role." **NOT SCORED.**
 - **Escalation on the other side of the ledger:** two Houthi salvos at Saudi Arabia (six ballistic missiles toward Taif and Yanbu on Sept 24; two missiles and two drones toward Khamis Mushait on Sept 25).
 - **★ A NEW STATE OF AFFAIRS this report had not recorded: no announced US strike on Iranian territory since Sept 1,** about 3.5 weeks — so the strikes clause that fired Aug 30 is now **NOT SCORED.**
 - **Corrected market and shipping figures, all labelled as market prices or tracker data.** Brent: \$106.60 close Sept 24 (+3.4%, intraday high \$108.23), \$104.37 Sept 25 (–2.09%) — superlatives *understated it, and is corrected.* An IMF PortWatch reading of 1 (Sept 20) uses PortWatch's own 85/day baseline and is **not mixed** with the Reuters series.
 - **Casualty-record corrections:** DCAS holds at **19** (11 hostile, 8 non-hostile). The 19th was **Capt. Bianca C. Wilkerson, posthumously promoted to major,** who died **Sept 18** of a cause **DCAS** and material enough to need its own pass.
 - **NOT SCORED, and it cuts against this cycle's own conclusion:** the WSJ reported Sept 25–26, citing unnamed US officials, that Trump **rejected** the seven-day plan and expects to resume talks. treatment this pillar gives anonymous claims in the other direction. Also not scored: The National's 60-day road map (still single-original-source, and a different frame that is not merged with t).
 - **Score decision: RE-RATED, window split, to 1/2/15/34/66** (–1/+2/+2/+1/0). **LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED** — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority.
 - **What would change my mind:** a *named* US official accepting or formally rejecting the seven-day plan would resolve the biggest ambiguity here in either direction; then a confirmed new US

Carried forward — what changed in the September 23 light daily touch (2026-09-23_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — a senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22) Iran can reopen the Strait of Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases military pressure and lifts its naval blockade** — Tehran Times, Sept 22.
- ★ **★ NEW — US and Iranian officials (Witkoff/Kushner for the US, FM Araghchi for Iran) held a three-hour mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines in New York, Sept 22.** scheduled "in the very near future." Corroborated across 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, Axios, The Hill, Times of Israel, New Arab, Al Arabiya) plus independent Iranian state-media confirmation.
- **Counterweights, logged and sized in:** Iran's conditions remain steep and unmet (full blockade lift, release of ALL frozen assets, end to war on every named "resistance front"); Pezeshkian rejected talks, and a single-source, unverified report of new US sanctions on Iran airline providers, are both flagged and NOT used.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED UP, modestly: 1mo 1 → 3, 3mo 1 → 3, 6mo 14 → 16, 12mo 33 → 35, 36mo held at 66.** No window moved more than 2 points; sourcing clears the primary-source-bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 22 light daily touch (2026-09-22_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- Not independently re-researched that cycle — a targeted single-pillar Fed & Macro follow-up (two regional Fed survey findings; see that pillar's report), not a fresh Iran War Risk research pass.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Not re-researched that cycle (targeted single-pillar touch) — carried forward from the Sept 19 weekly review. AUTO-STAMPED alongside Fed & Macro.

Carried forward — the September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh, for continuity:

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 19, 2026 (score set **2026-09-19_draft**, DRAFT — awaiting Alex's manual review) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-18_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66), via a full independent

- **Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal.** A further 130-lawmaker statement (Sept 7-13) urged parliament to begin the legal Article X withdrawal. Ministry still calls it "still being prepared" (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militaryny, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated, the same treatment).
- **Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime,** ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Axios independent). Still rhetoric about an undated future decision, not an action — but **the Sept 22 meeting itself is now flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle**.
- **The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposed Iran sanctions,** Russia and China vetoing (Somalia/Pakistan abstain). legal dispute over the 2025 "snapback" sanctions reimposition — institutional/procedural gridlock, ambiguous direction, not a new sanction or act of war. Does not move P.
- **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle's "not fired/not used" call, but is NOT used to move P:** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18 is confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmation or denial was found. This is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a new event.
- **MARKET PRICE, reported not scored:** Brent ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (down 1.5% day-over-day but still near multi-month highs, having spiked toward \$109 in early September on tanker/energy market).
- **Mixed proxy-front signal, neither clears the bar:** as of Sept 19, Iran has gone a ninth straight day without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, mixed signal.
- **Diplomatic wash, not used:** Iranian FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa News) that it was not a deal.
- **Research capability:** full WebSearch available, no degradation. WebFetch to arbitrary domains was blocked in this sandbox (relied on WebSearch summaries, not direct fetches of full UN press releases).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 18 light daily touch (2026-09-18_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 18, 2026 (score set **2026-09-18_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-17_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime,** ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Axios independent). already price maximal active-war uncertainty (1mo/3mo P=1), so it does not clear the bar for a further move.

- **Checked and NOT USED — a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz Sept 18.** An initial general search surfaced the claim; a follow-up — no P move on it either way.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set **2026-09-17_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-16_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Re-checked for a new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT-withdrawal statement — found none.** Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons status repair timeline, or Hormuz shipping.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 16 light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 16, 2026 (score set **2026-09-16_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar RE-RATED DOWN on the**

- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council** — a primary institutional escalation not previously priced by this pillar
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal**, with a hardline MP saying an emergency
- **Counterweight, logged:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared" — a real step, not
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, 1/1/18/38/70 → 1/1/14/33/66.** 1mo/3mo held at the floor (no room to move further); 6mo 18 → 14, 12mo 38 → 33, 36mo 70 → 66.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft, committed, auto-stamped, held flat), for continuity:

- **The Salalah ministerial remains postponed with no new date** — the fact that drove yesterday's re-rate down, unchanged. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds detail already consistent with what was consensus."
- **Saudi Arabia's East-West (Petroline) pipeline is still offline** — already priced Sept 12. Saudi energy-ministry sources put the loss at roughly **700,000 barrels a day**; Aramco has not said
- **INTERESTED-PARTY CLAIM, reported not scored:** Bloomberg (Sept 14) reports an *Iranian claim* that a tanker struck mines in the Strait of Hormuz. Uncorroborated by any independent pa
- **MARKET PRICES, reported not scored:** Brent closed above **\$105** and WTI rose toward **\$102** (Sept 14–15), slightly below yesterday's ~\$108 Brent print. Still inside the already-fired "sustain
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ ★ **NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact yesterday's upward re-rate was built on, and it did not survive the weekend.
- **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already**
- **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman cha stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian st draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement — which is why the 1-year window held one point above the Sept 12 level rather than fully retracing.
- **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored:** Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponem
- **Checked and REJECTED as stale:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated 1
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC ref Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated authority.

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ ★ **NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and I** waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. This is the first time high-level Iranian and GCC officials have gathered in one place since the war began in February. PRIMARY Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting ves
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13).
- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attribut
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and 0
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the meeti research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the sufficiency bar. The direction of the move is not itself a reason to withhold the stamp.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ ★ **NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone** Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both count
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL W**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad b with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Materially more severe than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill co
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.

- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause (Y) nor the flip-line clause (X) fired. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW** — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 40th largest oil refinery in the world (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera, The Daily Caller, SRN News, plus the Saudi Energy Ministry's own statement). Saudi Arabia is a repeat target.
- ★ **★ NEW** — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108 — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, ENR) — and the US Navy fired a missile at a suspected Iranian ship, which was also called fired.
- ★ **★ NEW** — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches — the first such referral in two decades.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3. Neither the widening clause (Y) nor the flip-line clause (X) fired. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces reported no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire either.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait**, a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line).
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained move.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island)** (GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship"). Both Iranian missile attempts evaded, no US casualties.
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24**, trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle has come to \$100.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any Iranian ship that enters** (The Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent attack is also circulating.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority:** status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an Iranian strike on a US Navy ship** (The Times).
- **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — no independent confirmation.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW** — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets. A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause (Y) fired.
- ★ **★ NEW** — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island. Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (independent) has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P per the sufficiency rule — WATCH NEXT CYCLE.
- **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuestak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolved the widening-to-a-new-state clause (Y).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100).
- **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW** — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike. IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, command and control centers, and oil tankers were hit.
- ★ **★ NEW** — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms), under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ **★ NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuestak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (independent).
- ★ **★ NEW** — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait. All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire.
- **NEW** — Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92 — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump).
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75) — 1mo -6, 3mo -6, 6mo -5, 12mo -3, 36mo -1; front-loaded, kept under the 8-point threshold, but this is a significant move. **COMMITTED** — **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call to action was clear.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting.** The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles.
- ★ **Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion** (The Times) and Iran International.
- ★ **President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran**, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahooo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- **Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports)** — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a repeat target.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1)** — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line. **COMMITTED** — **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026** once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call to action was clear.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two Iranian oil tankers, and a US Navy ship was hit. **declared downside flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).

• **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. AUTO

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, held P flat, left as draft, now superseded), for continuity:

- ★ "Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, **CONFIRMED** via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry. ~60 entities/infirm alerts. **For the first time, digital assets was named a sanctionable sector — 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, primary-confirmed, crypto-specific — unlike the "p
- ★ ★ **NEW** — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, **CONFIRMED** via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722. A genuine upgrade: every prior o Still "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance. No fee terms disclosed.
- **NEW** — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents, Aug 24 (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, cre
- **NEW** — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28: Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement
- **NEW** — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- **NEW** — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined, with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug
- **NEW** — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior w
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED** — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfir
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip lin
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76** — the confirmed sanctions escalation and the confirmed Oman corridor upgrade roughly offset; neither independently clears the sufficiency b

Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft), for audit continuity: that draft first logged the two Aug 24/27 tanker incidents, Trump's Aug 25 demining claim, and the IRGC revenue-sharing cl 21 gap.

Carried forward — what changed in the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23), for continuity: Background, for completeness: Aug 17, 18, and 20 drafts were each researched but n as not-delivered and independently re-verified via four parallel primary-source research passes, cutting P to 14/22/38/54/76 and delivering it as a draft. The Aug 22 full weekly refresh independently re-researched the pillar again

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel es
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — trea
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly)
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial re
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (specific trackers). This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) describ
- ★ **NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, v
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Chain
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → 14 · 3mo 28 → 22 · 6mo 41 → 38 · 12mo 56 → 54 · 36mo 77 → 76 — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft reasoning.

Sources

Retrieved & graded September 19, 2026, FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-19_draft; earlier sources below still stand for facts not re-checked this cycle) — click and judge the quality yourself. Official/primary sources sanctions-panel vote, the "Trend" tanker corroboration, oil prices, and the Iran-Oman Strait diplomatic track; no primary-source access degradation, though WebFetch to arbitrary domains was blocked in this sandbox (relied on

- **September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (this cycle):** Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News (Sept 7-13) — NPT-withdrawal process: 130-lawmaker statement, Parliament Presid Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News (Sept 17-18) — Trump's "big decision"/"annihilate" remark and the Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf renew the Iran-sanctions monitoring panel · IRNA (primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint), The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, Rio Times (Sept 17-18) — IRGC's own statement confirming the "Trend" tanker liveblog (Sept 19, Houthi-linked air-raid alert on Riyadh) — mixed proxy-front signal · TASS, Caspianpost, Mehr News, Samaa — FM Araghchi's Iran-Oman Strait "agreed a plan" claim and its own clarification that it will
- **September 18 light daily touch (prior cycle):** Axios — original interview, Trump's "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Sept 17, primary reporting of a direct quote) · Times of Israel, Politico Wire corroboration of a claimed IRGC strike on a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz, Sept 18 — no named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source found that quote; claim NOT corroborated, NOT
- **September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch: Oman News Agency (ONA) — state news agency statement, Sunday Sept 13, 2026: the Salalah regional meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to create condi** (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, "Oman postpones regional talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 13) · CNN, "Iran-Gulf talks without US participation on reopening the Strait of Hormuz postponed, Omani official says" (Sept and for Brent \$107.54 / WTI \$102.34, market prices) · Malay Mail, "Oman postpones Iran-Gulf talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 14) · Tehran Times / Mehr News, "FM Araghchi: Oman understanding not enough to reopen stale: Seatrade Maritime, Argus Media, Times of Israel and Gulf News reporting on drone strikes at Salalah and Duqm ports — those are dated March 1/3/11, 2026, and are not part of this cycle.
- **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to dis Monday," Sept 11 · Dawn, "Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz future," Sept 12 · Arab News · Oman Observer, "Salalah to host Iran-GCC Hormuz talks on Monday" · The Business Standard · Business R that it will not participate — logged counterweight · Jerusalem Post, "No signed Hormuz deal expected yet from Oman, Gulf States meeting on Monday, Iranian official says" — logged counterweight · Al Jazeera live blo Brent's 4.24% Friday Sept 11 give-back to ~\$104.26, reported as a market price and explicitly not used to move P.
- **September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (prior cycle):** Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Petroline) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, Sep — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shalamcheh border crossing closed · President Trump's on-record Dublin remarks — Iran "probably" responsible (single, hedged, unconfirmed); Ho restraint" · Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge — re-verification that the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure still holds · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$104.
- **September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning):** Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNN UKMTO Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two vessels near Khasab, Oman, one afire · Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill — corroborating reporting on the Khasab incident · Tr found · local run.py quant refresh — BTC \$76,745.60 (Sept 13) vs. \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
- **September 11 light daily catch-up:** Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102 NAI500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strike risk · Reuters wire via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tan summaries (flagged as a degraded pull, not used alone to move P).
- **September 10 light daily catch-up:** Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missile seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait · CNBC — Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, first time since May · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$101.25 Thursday Se \$77,993.99 (Sept 10) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8).
- **September 9 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, R both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries" (Sept 9) · ABC News — corroborating Brent ~\$100.44 intraday, +2.57% · standing DoD casualty records (checked d
- **September 8 light daily catch-up:** Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy announced), The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same Rezaei statement · GlobalSecurity.org — Iran War 2026 Day 192 update (GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6).
- **September 6 light daily catch-up:** CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, J live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sept 6) and Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian forces targeting a US naval drone) — Iran's own Sept 6 follow-on claims, not US-confirmed, N print) · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).

- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** *Blockchain.News* — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · *Blockchain.News* — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · *Direct P* by Jul 31" reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.